

“640 KB ought to be enough for anybody”, said Bill Gates in 1981. Things have changed a lot since then. Storage costs have dropped, and application sizes have increased. With the penetration of the Internet into almost every facet of our lives, online storage has also grown in popularity—it’s free and convenient. With that applauded, the benefits of the service are many—back up, sharing data and of course, a virtual briefcase to carry your business around in.

Since like money, no amount of space is ever enough, online storage is like an accommodating, omnipresent neighbour—everything that doesn’t find a place on your hard disk, can be put online. In limited measures, naturally. Once housed, you can share your stuff or transfer it across geographics.

There are several different types of online storage to

choose from. Some offer a paid solution and others let you store just about anything for free. Yet others are more specific, allowing you to store pictures and photo albums, providing you free Web space, either paid or unpaid.

Web sites that give you e-mail and Web hosting space can be used to store morsels of data. You can also use Web sites that offer high e-mail storage space. All you have to do is create an e-mail account with them, and then e-mail the files you want to back up to that address. Create appropriate folders, and you’re done.

Online Grand canyons

Sharemation.com (www.sharemation.com) is the first name that pops up when you talk of sites that offer free online storage space. This site is actually meant to be used when evaluating the Xythos WebFile server (www.xythos.com). The evaluation accounts have a storage space of 5 MB, and the site has an easy-to-use Web interface that allows you to copy, move, delete, or share files easily. You can even set file level permissions for shar-



Sharemation.com is a great online storage Web site to store your data

ing documents. Permission is granted on the basis of three levels of users—owners, Sharemation account holders and the general public. The address of your Web folder is as simple as <http://www.sharemation.com/<yourusername>>, and you can map this as a drive to easily drag and drop files. Just open Windows Explorer and go to **Tools > Map Network Drive...**, choose a drive letter in the ‘Drive’ field, and type the URL of your Web folder in the ‘Folder’ field. Now click on Finish, and you will be asked for a username and password. Enter them and click OK.

NetDocuments (<https://vault.netvoyage.com/>) offers a free space of 3 MB, with many useful features such as Web folders, e-mail accounts, etc. To sign up, visit [https:// vault.netvoyage.com/neWeb2/signup/signupfree.asp](https://vault.netvoyage.com/neWeb2/signup/signupfree.asp). This site only works if you run Windows with Internet Explorer 5.0,

It's Never Enough

Tired of using floppies and CDs to haul your data around? Try these free online storage services and access your documents from anywhere...

IMAGING: Atul Deshmukh